

Hybrid Gaming Platform — Team Code of Conduct

1. Purpose

This Code of Conduct defines the standards of professional behaviour, collaboration, responsibility, and ethical decision-making expected from everyone working on the Hybrid Gaming Platform.

Our team is responsible for developing a platform that combines physical and online board/card gaming, real-time interaction, video streaming, player reputation, payments, tournaments, and financial rewards. Because the platform may process personal information and real money and must actively prevent fraud, all team members are expected to place **fairness, security, privacy, transparency, and user trust** at the centre of development.

This Code of Conduct applies to all members of the project team throughout requirements analysis, design, implementation, testing, deployment, documentation, and project management.

2. Respect and Professional Behaviour

Every team member must treat other members with respect regardless of their role, experience, background, gender, nationality, culture, beliefs, or technical ability.

Discrimination, harassment, intimidation, personal attacks, offensive comments, and deliberately disruptive behaviour will not be tolerated.

Technical disagreements are expected and encouraged when they improve the project. However, criticism must focus on the **idea, design, requirement, or implementation**, rather than the individual who proposed it.

Team members should actively listen to different opinions and allow everyone a reasonable opportunity to contribute.

3. Scrum Team Collaboration

The team will follow Scrum principles and work collaboratively toward the agreed Product Goal and Sprint Goals.

Team members are expected to:

- Attend and participate in relevant Scrum events, including Sprint Planning, Daily Scrum, Sprint Review, and Sprint Retrospective.
- Communicate blockers and risks as early as possible.
- Keep assigned work and task status accurate and visible to the team.
- Avoid claiming that incomplete or untested work is complete.
- Respect the agreed Definition of Done.
- Support other team members when necessary rather than focusing only on individual tasks.
- Give constructive feedback during reviews and retrospectives.
- Respect decisions made collectively by the team after reasonable discussion.

The team should promote collective ownership of the product rather than creating isolated areas that only one person understands.

4. Accountability and Transparency

Each team member is accountable for the work they contribute.

Progress, problems, technical limitations, security weaknesses, failed tests, and mistakes must be communicated honestly. Team members must not hide problems simply to make a Sprint or project milestone appear successful.

If a mistake occurs, the priority should be understanding its cause, correcting it, and preventing recurrence rather than assigning blame.

Significant architectural, security, financial, or requirements decisions should be documented so that the reasoning behind them can later be reviewed.

5. Secure Development

Security is a core requirement of the Hybrid Gaming Platform rather than an optional feature.

Team members must follow secure development practices when designing, implementing, reviewing, and testing the system.

Particular care must be taken with:

- User authentication and authorization
- Player identities and profiles
- Payment and financial information
- Tournament prizes and player winnings
- Game results
- Reputation scores
- Administrative privileges
- APIs and third-party integrations
- Video streams and recordings
- Logs and audit information

Security vulnerabilities discovered during development must be reported to the team and handled according to their severity. They must not be deliberately concealed.

Production credentials, API keys, passwords, private keys, or other secrets must never be committed to source-control repositories or unnecessarily shared between team members.

6. Fraud Prevention and Game Integrity

Because fraud prevention is a major business priority, every team member shares responsibility for protecting the integrity of games and financial transactions.

The platform should be designed so that important actions can be verified and investigated when necessary.

Examples include:

- Player deposits and payments
- Entry fees

- Withdrawals
- Tournament prizes
- Game outcomes
- Reputation changes
- Administrative actions
- Suspicious account activity

Developers must not intentionally introduce mechanisms that allow themselves, another team member, an administrator, or a player to manipulate game results, player balances, reputation scores, or financial records without appropriate authorization and auditability.

Suspected fraud, manipulation, or abuse must be reported through the agreed project process and investigated rather than ignored.

7. Fairness

Online and physical participants should receive fair treatment wherever technically possible.

The team must avoid intentionally designing functionality that gives hidden advantages to particular players, administrators, dealers, game masters, locations, or commercial partners.

Rules affecting player eligibility, ranking, reputation, payments, prizes, penalties, or game outcomes should be understandable and consistently applied.

Any algorithm that materially influences player reputation, matchmaking, fraud detection, or access to games should have clearly documented objectives and decision criteria.

8. Privacy and Data Protection

Only information that is reasonably required for operating, securing, improving, or legally administering the platform should be collected.

Personal information must only be accessed by team members who require it for legitimate project purposes.

Information obtained through the project must not be copied, disclosed, or used for unrelated personal purposes.

Video recordings require particular care because games may involve both online participants and people physically present at gaming locations. The system should provide appropriate information and consent mechanisms concerning recording, storage, and subsequent viewing.

Privacy and data-protection requirements must be considered during system design rather than added only after implementation.

9. Financial Responsibility

Features involving money must receive additional scrutiny because errors or abuse could cause direct financial harm to users and the company.

Financial functionality should provide appropriate:

- Authorization
- Validation
- Transaction records
- Audit trails
- Error handling
- Reconciliation
- Fraud controls
- Access restrictions

No team member may manipulate test or production financial information for personal benefit.

Production financial transactions must never be performed merely for testing purposes unless specifically authorized through an approved testing procedure.

10. Responsible Use of Access

Team members may receive privileged access to source code, databases, development environments, logs, player information, analytics, or administrative systems.

Such access must only be used for legitimate project activities.

Team members must not use privileged access to inspect private user information out of curiosity, modify player information without authorization, manipulate games or balances, or provide unauthorized access to another person.

Administrative and privileged actions should be auditable wherever practical.

11. Quality and Code Review

Changes affecting important functionality should undergo appropriate review and testing before being considered complete.

Particular attention must be given to code involving:

- Authentication
- Authorization
- Payments
- Player balances
- Game-state synchronization
- Tournament results
- Reputation
- Fraud detection
- Video access
- Personal information

Team members should write maintainable and understandable code and provide documentation where another developer would otherwise have difficulty understanding the implementation.

Code reviews should be constructive and should focus on improving quality rather than criticizing the author.

12. Responsible Use of AI and External Code

AI-generated code, open-source code, online examples, and third-party libraries must not automatically be assumed to be correct or secure.

The team member introducing such code remains responsible for reviewing, understanding, testing, and appropriately licensing it.

Confidential source code, credentials, private user information, financial information, or other restricted project information must not be submitted to unauthorized external AI systems or other third-party services.

13. Conflicts of Interest

Team members must disclose conflicts of interest that could reasonably influence project decisions.

This becomes particularly important if the company acquires or merges with competitors, integrates external gaming providers, or enters commercial relationships with game operators.

Technical recommendations should be based on the interests and requirements of the project rather than undisclosed personal or commercial interests.

14. International and Future Expansion

The platform should be designed with future expansion in mind.

Team members should avoid unnecessary assumptions that permanently restrict the system to one country, language, currency, payment provider, gaming regulation, or physical gaming location.

However, future international expansion must not be used as justification for ignoring the legal, regulatory, security, or user requirements of the initial market.

15. Intellectual Property and Confidentiality

Project source code, architecture, business information, credentials, internal documentation, user information, and other confidential materials must be handled responsibly.

Team members must respect software licenses, copyrights, trademarks, and other intellectual-property rights.

Code or assets from external sources must not be copied into the project unless their use is legally and technically appropriate.

Confidential project information must not be shared publicly without authorization.

16. Reporting Problems

Team members are encouraged to raise concerns relating to:

- Security vulnerabilities
- Fraud
- Privacy violations
- Financial irregularities
- Unethical behaviour
- Harassment or discrimination
- Deliberate manipulation of game results
- Serious quality problems
- Violations of this Code of Conduct

Concerns should initially be raised with the Scrum Master, Product Owner, or another designated project authority, depending on the nature of the issue.

Serious security, financial, fraud, or legal concerns should be escalated immediately rather than waiting for the next Scrum event.

A team member raising a legitimate concern in good faith should not face retaliation for doing so.

17. Resolving Team Conflicts

Where possible, disagreements should first be resolved through respectful discussion between the people involved.

If the disagreement cannot be resolved, the Scrum Master should facilitate a discussion.

Product-priority questions should ultimately be resolved through the Product Owner, while significant technical decisions should be resolved collaboratively by the developers using documented technical evidence where possible.

Security, privacy, financial, and legal concerns must not be overruled simply to meet a Sprint deadline.

18. Violations

Minor violations should normally be addressed through discussion and corrective action.

Repeated or serious violations should be escalated to the Scrum Master, Product Owner, project supervisor, or appropriate organizational authority.

Severe violations involving fraud, deliberate security compromise, unauthorized financial manipulation, harassment, theft of information, or intentional privacy violations may require immediate escalation and removal of system access.

19. Team Commitment

By participating in the Hybrid Gaming Platform project, each team member agrees to:

1. Act professionally and respectfully.
2. Work transparently and collaboratively.
3. Protect player and company information.
4. Prioritize security and fraud prevention.
5. Protect the integrity and fairness of games.
6. Handle financial functionality responsibly.
7. Report significant risks and vulnerabilities.
8. Respect intellectual property and confidentiality.
9. Produce work that can be reviewed and maintained by others.
10. Take responsibility for the quality and ethical impact of their contributions.

This Code of Conduct should be reviewed periodically during Sprint Retrospectives and updated if new risks, technologies, regulations, or working practices emerge.

Project: Hybrid Gaming Platform

Team Size: 10 members

Development Methodology: Scrum

Version: 1.0

Date: September 2026